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Reptiles (crawling and creeping things)

4.2 Reptiles (crawling and creeping things)

References:

Hebrew זחל (zachal) DEU 32:24, MIC 7:17

Hebrew רֶמֶשׂ (remes) GEN 1:24, GEN 1:25, GEN 1:26, GEN 6:7, GEN 6:20, GEN 7:14, GEN 7:23, GEN 8:19, GEN 9:3, 1KI 5:13, PSA 104:25, PSA 148:10, EZK 8:10, EZK 38:20, HOS 2:20, HAB 1:14

Hebrew שֶׁרֶץ (sherets) GEN 7:21, LEV 5:2, LEV 11:10, LEV 11:20, LEV 11:21, LEV 11:23, LEV 11:29, LEV 11:31, LEV 11:41, LEV 11:42, LEV 11:43, LEV 11:44, LEV 22:5

Greek ἑρπετόν (herpeton) ACT 10:12, ACT 11:6, ROM 1:23, JAS 3:7, WIS 11:15, WIS 17:9, SIR 10:11, LJE 1:19

Latin reptilis 2ES 6:53

Discussion:

The Hebrew words zachal and remes literally mean “creeping [things]” or “crawling [things]“, which is the Hebrew way of referring to small unclean creatures, reptiles in particular. The Hebrew word sherets literally means “swarming things” and refers to mammals and reptiles that move close to the ground in groups or swarms. In Israel some vipers give birth to live offspring that live near each other until full maturity. They congregate near each other again at mating time. These vipers are included in the term sherets. The Greek word herpeton is also a general word for reptile; it includes snakes and lizards. All of the Hebrew, Greek, and Latin words usually exclude fish, the one possible exception being GEN 1:20.

Special significance or symbolism:

The Hebrew words carry the connotation of uncleanness.

Translation:

In languages which have a word meaning “reptile“, this will fit most contexts. In languages which do not, phrases such as “snakes and lizards”, “wriggling things“, and so forth could be used.